

Anand Chandrasekher, senior vice president, Qualcomm Technologies, in a statement.

While these processors are yet to be available in the server market, Qualcomm has started its commercial sampling. The company even conducted a live demonstration of the new chip running Linux-based Apache Spark and Hadoop.

Qualcomm is attempting to steal the march over Intel by developing the Centriq family. The top-end Intel chip supports 24 cores, whereas Qualcomm's latest offering comes with up to 48 cores. Also, this is the first time an ARM architecture is moving towards servers. This will encourage the market to leverage a powerful performance alongside open source software, as ARM-based chips are not likely to support the applications designed for x86 architecture.

The performance results will be out following the commercial availability of the Qualcomm Centriq 2400, which is expected to begin in the second half of 2017.

Microsoft R Server 9.0 enhances machine learning efforts

Microsoft has released R Server 9.0 to bring machine learning close to servers. The new update includes some cutting-edge algorithms within an all-new MicrosoftML package to make server technologies smarter than ever before.



Microsoft R Server 9.0 allows a combination of the latest algorithms with the conventional open source CRAN R packages and preloaded parallel external memory algorithms like the RevoScaleR package. There are offerings like a fast linear learner, GPU-

accelerated Deep Neural Networks with convolutions and fast random forest.

Alongside the algorithms, the updated R Server improves some existing operationalisation capabilities. There is an option to convert existing R models and scripts into Web services using a single-line code on IDE such as R Tools for Visual Studio, RStudio or Jupyter Notebooks. Also, the R Server simplifies the application integration experience from the Swagger standard and brings cross-platform support to train models.

Microsoft has also introduced support for Spark 2.0, an upgrade from Spark 1.6. This change offers new methodologies for handling streaming data and includes an advanced memory management sub-system to improve performance.

"With this latest release, you have access to a powerful tool, one that supports popular operating systems and a variety of data sources, helping you to create sophisticated analytics models and deploy them in the real world, efficiently and at scale," said Nagesh Pabbisetty, partner director of programme management, Microsoft, in a statement.

Microsoft R Server 9.0 can be deployed on Ubuntu in addition to other platforms. This means the new R Server can be a part of SUSE and Red Hat

CoreOS gets transformed into Container Linux; enables self-driving Kubernetes

Security-centric CoreOS has made a couple of major announcements. The open source platform has been transformed into Container Linux and added self-driving Kubernetes support.

The CoreOS team has designed self-driving Kubernetes to let organisations enjoy an up-to-date experience with the latest patches and features. This new development offers auto updates alongside patches, upgrades and vulnerability responses.



"With the self-driving Kubernetes platform, users get the most advanced version of Kubernetes with the comfort of knowing that security updates can be patched seamlessly," said Alex Polvi, CEO of CoreOS, in a blog post. The self-driving Kubernetes is available as an option within CoreOS Tectonic that works on up to 10 nodes.

In addition to the latest Kubernetes development, CoreOS has differentiated between the open source distribution and its own brand by launching Container Linux. This platform comes along with a new logo. "Over the years, CoreOS (the brand) has grown to represent not just a product but the leadership and expertise we provide to our customers and in the open community," Polvi stated.

The original CoreOS platform has over one million unique instances on a monthly basis. The distribution was initially developed to secure the Internet. However, it is now streamlined for containers and delivers an upgraded platform with the auto-update capability.